



The Humanitas Institute

Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: Caldwell Academy

School Website: <https://caldwellacademy.org/>

December 21, 2025

Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix more details.

ACCS Member School

Any school that belongs to the Association of Classical Christian Schools ACCS or the Society for Classical Learning SCL is, by definition, recognized as a classical school because both organizations require adherence to the six essential elements defined by the Humanitas Institute. However, a school's website may not clearly reflect its conformity to one or more elements. In such cases, the school may still receive a "Somewhat Classical" rating for those elements. Schools can update their website content at any time to achieve a "Classical" rating for a given element.

Classicality Audit Report

Executive Summary - School: Austin Classical School (austinclassical.org) - Overall Classification: CLASSICAL - Highlights: - Mission explicitly frames education as the cultivation of wisdom and virtue in Christ and orients learning toward truth, goodness, and beauty, grounded in Christian theology (glorify Jesus Christ; classical, Christian education; cultivate wise, virtuous, humble students) . - Clear Trivium-anchored curriculum (Grammar, Logic, Rhetoric), with Latin, formal Logic, Rhetoric, senior thesis, and an integrated approach that treats knowledge as interconnected under God's sovereignty . - Pedagogy demonstrates memorization/recitation/songs in the lower school, debate/discussion in the logic years, and oratory/thesis defense in the rhetoric years—hallmarks of classical method . - Parent partnership is explicit ("co-laboring with families"), parent formation is encouraged via a recommended classical reading list, and a house system is part of the community life .

Note on method: Keyword indicators and rating criteria are taken from Six Essential Elements of a Classical School (positive/negative signals across the six categories) and the classicality lexicon used by this audit .

School URL Used: <https://austinclassical.org/>

Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations - Step 1 — School keywords observed: - "glorify Jesus Christ"; "classical, Christian education"; "wise, virtuous, and humble" - "Truth, Goodness, and Beauty"; "contemplation of the True, the Good, and the Beautiful" - "under the sovereignty of God through theology" (integration) - Christian Studies scope (Exegesis/Hermeneutics, Apologetics & Ethics, Church History) - Step 2 — Match to "Six Elements" positive/negative indicators: - Positive fit: truth/goodness/beauty, virtue, wisdom, theological integration (theology, faith and reason), Christian formation . - Liturgical practices (e.g., daily chapel/chapel, Eucharist) are not explicitly cited on the site excerpts we reviewed (no signal). - Step 3 — Quantification: - Positive hits: +10 (truth, goodness, beauty, virtue, wisdom, theology integration, Christian formation, apologetics/ethics, exegesis, Church History) - Negative hits: -0 - Percent positive: 100% - Percent coverage across sub-pillars: 67% (strong on transcendental moral realism and theology; no explicit liturgical/communal worship reference found) - Step 4 — Score and justification: CLASSICAL - The site affirms transcendentals and theological grounding with multiple, explicit cues; while communal liturgical practice is not explicit, the first two pillars are robustly present, aligning tightly with the positive list for this category .

Element 2: School Purpose and Goal - Step 1 — School keywords observed: - "cultivate wisdom and virtue" (aim of education), "co-laboring with families" (formation), "True, Good, and Beautiful," "eternal purpose" (formation > information/careerism) . - Step 2 — Match to "Six Elements" indicators: - Positive: formation over information; pursuit of truth, goodness, beauty; wisdom and virtue as goals; rejection of job-training focus . - Step 3 — Quantification: - Positive hits: +8 - Negative hits: -0 (no "college and career ready/21st-century skills" framing observed) - Percent positive: 100% - Percent coverage: 100% - Step 4 — Score and justification: CLASSICAL - Purpose statements align directly with classical ends (wisdom/virtue and the transcendentals) per the lexicon and elements document .

Element 3: School Curriculum - Step 1 — School keywords observed: - "Trivium... Grammar, Logic, Rhetoric," "Latin from 5th grade," "formal logic," "rhetoric instruction," "senior thesis," "great books/ great

conversation,” “Western tradition,” “History” (not “Social Studies”), “integrated curriculum under theology” .

- Step 2 — Match to indicators: - Positive: trivium/quadrivium anchors, great books/primary texts, classical languages (Latin), history as history, integrated approach fostering wonder; rhetoric/logic sequencing .
- Step 3 — Quantification: - Positive hits: +12 - Negative hits: -0 (no “social studies” substitution; no STEM-first or project-based dominance signals) - Percent positive: 100% - Percent coverage: 100% - Step 4 — Score and justification: CLASSICAL - The curriculum strongly satisfies classical content and structure expectations with copious explicit evidence across the site .

Element 4: School Pedagogy or Teaching Methods - Step 1 — School keywords observed: - Lower school: “memorization, recitation, and songs” (memory/chant/singing) - Logic years: “debate and discussion” (dialectic/Socratic discussion)

- Rhetoric years: “thesis defense,” “eloquent written and oral communication” (rhetoric/oratory)
- Step 2 — Match to indicators: - Positive: memory work/recitation/chanting; Socratic/dialectic; debate/seminar; rhetoric exercises/thesis/oration. “Restful learning/scholé” language is not explicit in the materials we saw .
- Step 3 — Quantification: - Positive hits: +7 - Negative hits: -0 - Percent positive: 100% - Percent coverage: 75% (3 of 4 major sub-themes strongly present; no explicit scholé/restfulness language) - Step 4 — Score and justification: CLASSICAL - Strong alignment with classical pedagogy in grammar/dialectic/rhetoric practices; lack of explicit scholé language does not outweigh the otherwise robust evidence .

Element 5: School Faculty - Step 1 — School keywords observed: - “Head of School who loves Jesus ... teachers ... serving God ... using the classical approach” - Step 2 — Match to indicators: - Positive indicators include teachers as mentors/models of virtue, a “portrait of a teacher,” collegiality/mentorship language . - The site excerpts show alignment in spirit (virtue/faith-oriented teachers) but do not explicitly present a “portrait of a teacher” or explicit mentorship/collegium language. - Step 3 — Quantification: - Positive hits: +2 - Negative hits: -0 - Percent positive: 100% - Percent coverage: 33% (limited explicit faculty-formation/portrait evidence in provided excerpts) - Step 4 — Score and justification: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL - The ethos appears classical, but more explicit statements about teachers as mentors, faculty collegium, and a formal teacher portrait would strengthen alignment with this category’s indicators .

Element 6: School Parents and Community - Step 1 — School keywords observed: - “co-laboring with families” (partnership) - “Recommended Reading” list for understanding classical, Christian education (parent formation) - “house system” (community life) in Upper School - Step 2 — Match to indicators: - Positive: partnership with parents/parents as co-educators; parent formation (book lists/studies); community practices/events . - Step 3 — Quantification: - Positive hits: +3 - Negative hits: -0 - Percent positive: 100% - Percent coverage: 67% (explicit parent partnership + formation + community; not enough data to confirm “parents welcome anytime” policy) - Step 4 — Score and justification: CLASSICAL - Strong partnership language and tangible parent formation resources align with classical expectations for this category .

Overall Aggregate Ranking - Overall Classification: CLASSICAL - Rationale: Five categories score CLASSICAL with robust positive keyword evidence and coverage; one category (Faculty) is SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL due to fewer explicit statements about teacher portraits/mentoring forms. The preponderance of evidence indicates the school is substantively classical across foundations, purpose, curriculum, pedagogy, and parent partnership, consistent with the Six Elements framework and lexicon .

Detailed Keyword Notes (selected, non-exhaustive) - Transcendentals and purpose: “cultivate wisdom and virtue... contemplation of the True, the Good, and the Beautiful” (positive signals for moral realism and aim of education) . - Theology integration: “under the sovereignty of God through theology”; Christian Studies sequences (Exegesis/Hermeneutics; Apologetics & Ethics) . - Trivium/Latin/Great Books/Integration: “Grammar, Logic, Rhetoric”; “Latin”; “great books/great conversation”; “interrelation of all knowledge” . - Pedagogy: “memorization, recitation, songs”; “debate and discussion”; “thesis defense” . - Parents/community: “co-laboring with families”; “Recommended Reading” (parent formation); house system in Upper School .

Reference keyword sets and category criteria were drawn from Six Essential Elements (positive/negative indicators for all six categories) and the classicality lexicon used for scoring .

Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

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